P210

HISTORY

Paper 1

2026

3 hours

EBC EDUCATION CONSULT

Uganda Advance Certificate of Education

HISTORY

SET I

Paper 1

(World Socio-Economic and Political History Since 1800)

3 hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES:

*This examination paper consists of **two** sections: **A** and **B**. It has **four** examination items.*

*Section **A** has two **compulsory** items.*

*Section **B** has two items. Respond to **one** item.*

*Respond to **three** items in **all**.*

*Any additional item responded to will **not** be scored*

Begin each item on a fresh page.

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SECTION A

*(Respond to **all items** in this section)*

Item 1

In the late nineteenth century, Sudan was under Turco-Egyptian rule, supported by the Ottoman Empire. The administration faced heavy taxation, corruption, forced recruitment and interference in local affairs. Many Sudanese were also dissatisfied with the growing influence of foreigners and the weakening of Islamic practices. In this atmosphere, Muhammad Ahmad ibn Abd Allah emerged in 1881, declaring himself the Mahdi, a divinely guided Islamic leader. He called for the purification of Islam and resistance against foreign rule. His message attracted peasants, religious followers, tribal groups and former soldiers. The movement rapidly grew into the Mahdist Revolt.

The Mahdists defeated several government forces and captured Khartoum in January 1885, where General Charles Gordon was killed. The Mahdists established their own state, but internal divisions, military pressure and later British-Egyptian intervention weakened the movement. In 1898, the Mahdist forces were defeated at the Battle of Omdurman, and Anglo-Egyptian control was restored.

The revolt therefore presents a historical contradiction: religion united different groups and inspired resistance against oppression, yet religious zeal, political rivalry and military confrontation also contributed to destruction and loss of life.

Task:

(a) Assess the causes and effects of the Mahdist Revolt on the people and political development of Sudan.

(b) Analyse the lessons from the above events to understand how religious beliefs can be used to promote unity and positive social change rather than conflict.

Item 2

A district education officer in Uganda found that many school leavers were struggling to secure employment despite having completed secondary education. Employers complained that some graduates had academic knowledge but lacked practical skills, creativity, problem-solving abilities and knowledge that could be applied to local development challenges.

During a stakeholders' meeting, learners observed that much of what they studied was based on ideas and examples from outside Africa, while Ugandan history, culture, indigenous knowledge, local resources and community challenges received less attention. However, some employers warned that learners should not be cut off from useful international knowledge because the modern job market is increasingly global and requires skills such as digital literacy, innovation, communication and adaptability.

The stakeholders therefore disagreed on whether Uganda should replace foreign-oriented content with African knowledge or adapt education to African realities while equipping learners with skills to compete globally.

Task:

(a) Analyse how education can be used to address the identified challenges and contribute to the modernisation and development of Uganda.

(b) Evaluate the efforts to Africanise Uganda's curriculum to understand how education can balance African/Ugandan needs with the demands of the global job market.

SECTION B

(Respond to only ***one item*** from this section)

Item 3

One of the largest African countries is facing a serious national crisis. The country is divided into several regions with different political interests, some communities are demanding greater autonomy, and foreign powers are supporting rival groups. As a result, national identity and unity are weakening, creating conflicts that are affecting development.

During a national dialogue to find possible solutions to the challenges, one group proposes using political negotiations and alliances, another advocates military action, while others believe that popular mobilisation and a strong nationalist movement are necessary to unite the country. A historian reminds the leaders that Italy faced a similar problem in the nineteenth century when its territories were divided among different states and some were under foreign control. Through the actions of different nationalist leaders, diplomacy, alliances, military campaigns and popular support, Italy achieved unification by 1870.

To find everlasting solutions, the government asks historians to study the Italian experience and use it to help identify possible ways of addressing their country's crisis.

Task:

(a) Analyse how different processes and actors contributed to the unification of Italy by 1870.

(b) Evaluate the lessons from the Italian experience that could help African countries address the challenges in the scenario.

Item 4

Uganda has recently experienced debates over the interpretation and amendment of the Constitution, the limits of government power, citizens' rights, and the effectiveness of Parliament in representing the people. During a public discussion, some citizens argued that leaders who are elected by the people should have wide powers to make decisions in the interests of the country. Others questioned this view, arguing that even elected leaders must exercise power within the limits of the Constitution and respect the rights of citizens.

The debate became more intense when some citizens claimed that Parliament sometimes makes decisions without adequately reflecting the views of the people who elected its members. Other citizens responded that Parliament is the constitutional institution through which citizens exercise their sovereignty by choosing representatives to debate laws, scrutinise government and participate in national decision-making.

The disagreement raised a key question: If Ugandans are sovereign, what limits should exist on the power exercised in their name, and how can Parliament ensure that their voices are genuinely reflected in governance? History learners were asked to examine the situation and provide guidance.

Task:

(a) Analyse how sovereignty and constitutionalism can help Uganda address challenges in the scenario while protecting citizens' rights, responsibilities and limiting the exercise of power.

(b) Evaluate the role of Parliament in representing the will and voice of Ugandans to understand the ways of strengthening its contribution to inclusive governance.

END